

ITINERARY SOODY NELSON & FAMILY
PORTUGAL - SEP/24



GETTING TO KNOW US

He is a Historian and an Architect, born and raised in Lisbon.

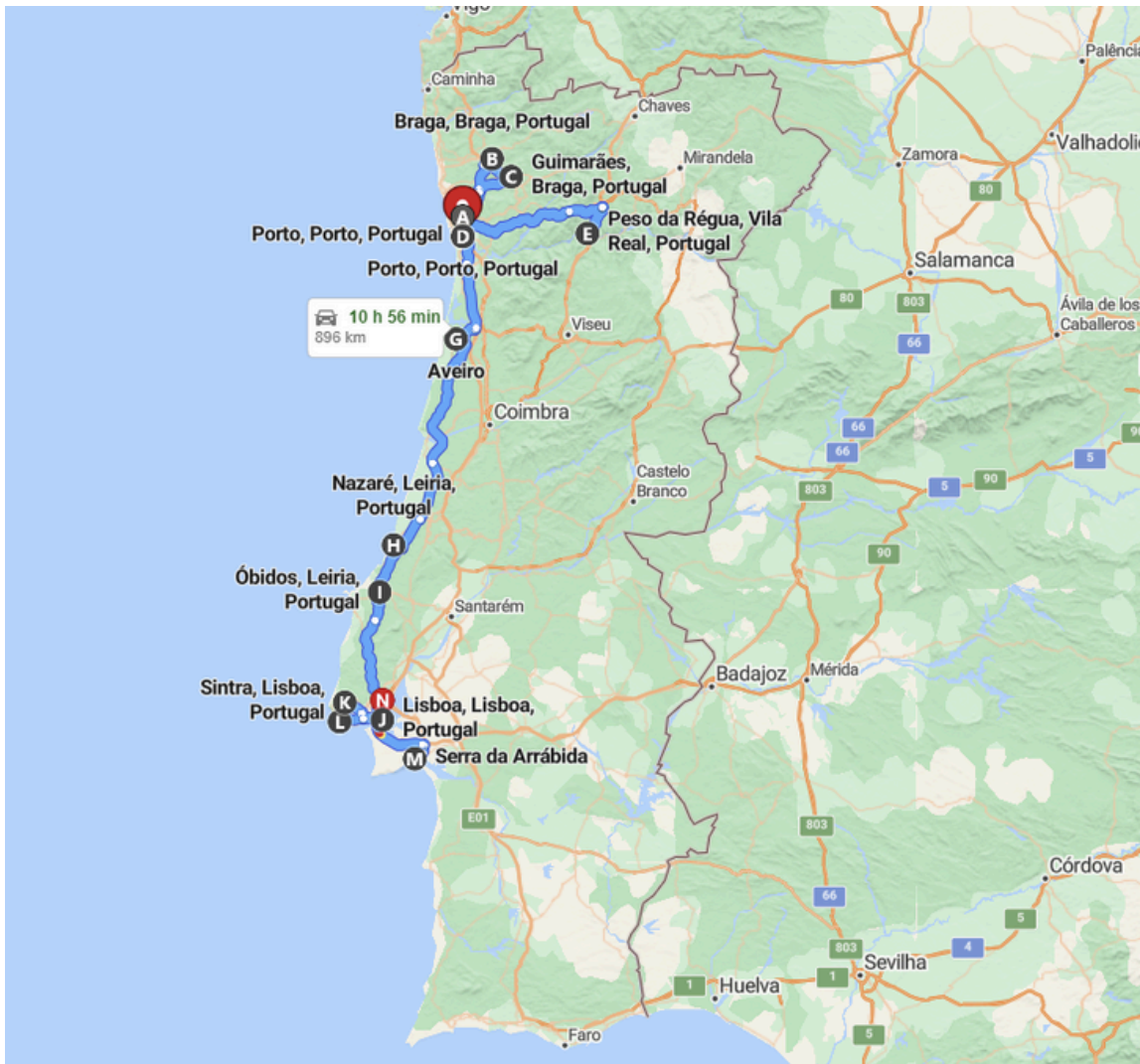
She is a Luxury Travel Journalist, a world citizen who found home in Lisbon.

Together we run a bespoke travel agency whose mission is to showcase the heart and soul of our land, ensuring you fall in love with our country and feel inspired to return time and time again.

Meet Tiago and Adriana, your guides in Portugal & Spain.



MAP & ITINERARIES



TRIP DISTANCES

DAY 01: Porto arrival & city tour

DAY 02: Braga, Guimarães [90 mi, 2h]

DAY 03: Douro - Casa Mateus, Olive Oil Farm [160 mi, 3h]

DAY 04: Douro - Wineries & Douro Cruise [180 mi, 3h30]

DAY 05: Sep 24, Tue - Aveiro - Costa Nova - Gaia Port Caves [130 mi, 2h30]

DAY 06: Sep 25, Wed - Porto - Nazaré - Óbidos - Lisbon [220 mi, 4h30]

DAY 07: Sep 26, Thu - Lisbon city tour

DAY 08: Sep 27, Fri - Sintra - Cabo da Roca - Cascais [90 mi, 2h]

DAY 09: Sep 28, Sat- Azeitão, Serra d'Arrábida, Setúbal [90 mi, 2h]

DAY 10: Sep 29, Sun - Departure from Lisbon

PORTO - ARRIVAL & CITY TOUR

MORNING

Arrival in Porto
Transfer from Airport to Hotel
Check-in at hotel

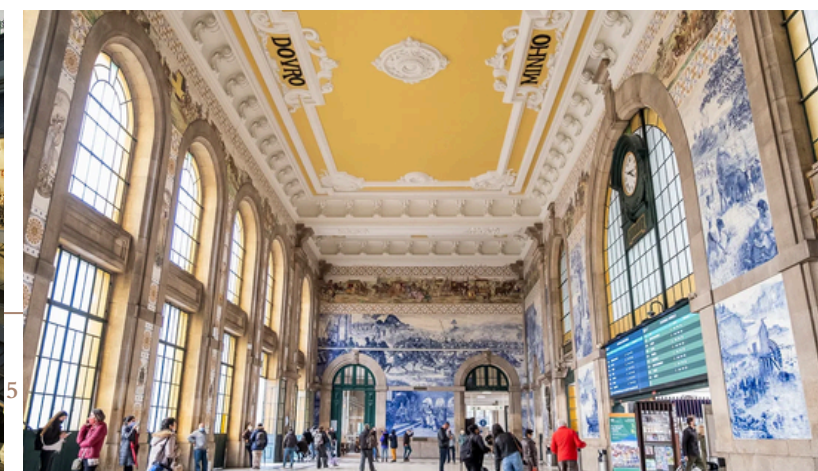
LUNCH & AFTERNOON

We head to the riverside to enjoy lunch with the most famous view of Porto.

In the afternoon, we explore Porto's historical district, a city shaped by its prosperous port wine trade that flourished in the 18th century, especially with the arrival of English merchants who established renowned companies like Sandeman and Offley, bypassing intermediaries. Unlike Lisbon, which suffered significant damage from the 1755 earthquake, Porto remained intact, allowing its rich heritage to be beautifully preserved.

EVENING

Free



PORTO - BRAGA - GUIMARÃES - PORTO

MORNING

Trip Porto – Braga – 40 mi, 50 min

We embark on a journey to Braga, one of Portugal's oldest cities, often called the "Portuguese Rome," with roots stretching back over 2,000 years. Founded by the Romans, Braga once rivaled Santiago de Compostela in both power and significance.

Our tour takes us through the historic center, with a stop at the iconic Café Vianna, which has been a cultural hub since its opening in 1871. Known as one of the country's oldest cafés, it has welcomed a range of notable figures, including journalists, politicians, and writers like Eça de Queirós and Camilo Castelo Branco, who often referenced it in their works.



Trip Braga – Guimarães - 15 mi, 30 min

Our journey continues to Guimarães, known as the birthplace of Portugal, where the nation's first king, Afonso Henriques, was born. Here, we will visit two of the city's most iconic landmarks: the historic Guimarães Castle and the majestic Ducal Palace.

LUNCH

We'll enjoy lunch at a traditional restaurant in the iconic Largo da Oliveira, located in the heart of the historic center. This is also the perfect chance to savor one of the city's beloved desserts, Toucinho do Céu, a local delicacy.

PORTO - BRAGA - GUIMARÃES - PORTO

AFTERNOON

We will stroll around its well-preserved historic center, a UNESCO World Heritage site, where we'll find narrow cobblestone streets, traditional squares, and a captivating blend of medieval and modern architecture. Guimarães offers a unique journey through Portugal's past in a setting that feels timeless.



Trip Guimarães – Porto – 40 mi, 50 min

We return to Porto in the late afternoon.

EVENING

Free

DOURO: CASA DE MATEUS, OLIVE OIL FARM

MORNING

Viagem: 60 mi, 1h20 min

We set off to explore the Douro region, beginning with a visit to Vila Real and the stunning Fundação da Casa de Mateus.

Built in the early 18th century, the Mateus Palace is surrounded by exquisite gardens and is renowned as one of Portugal's finest examples of Baroque architecture. This magnificent estate includes the main house, chapel, and winery, along with historic gardens, orchards, vineyards, and woodland. Inside, you'll find intricately carved wooden ceilings, period furniture, 17th- and 18th-century paintings, silverware, ceramics, and a library housing a rare edition of **Os Lusíadas**.

Our visit includes a guided tour of the Casa de Mateus, offering a deeper look into its rich history and collections.



DOURO: CASA DE MATEUS, OLIVE OIL FARM

LUNCH

Lunch at a traditional restaurant.

AFTERNOON

We'll take a scenic drive through some of the region's most picturesque villages before embarking on one of the trip's highlights: a visit to a traditional olive oil mill.

Here, we'll witness the artisanal production of olive oil, descending the property's slopes in a jeep to explore the cultivation of centuries-old olive trees. Along the way, the owner will share fascinating insights and amusing stories about the land.

To complete the experience, we'll enjoy a tasting of freshly produced olive oil, paired with other homegrown ingredients lovingly prepared by his wife.

Trip Douro - Porto: 75 mi, 1h30



EVENING

Free

DOURO: WINERIES & DOURO CRUISE

FULL DAY

Viagem: 170 mi, 4h

A road trip from Porto to the Douro Valley is a journey through one of Portugal's most stunning landscapes. As you leave the city behind, the road winds through rolling hills, terraced vineyards, and alongside the shimmering Douro River.

The valley, famous for its Port wine production, offers breathtaking views at every turn. Along the way, we will pass by charming villages, visit historic wineries for tastings, and take in the beauty of this UNESCO World Heritage site, making it an unforgettable scenic adventure.

We'll visit two exceptional wineries, where you'll dive into the art and tradition of Port wine production. As you explore the cellars and vineyards, you'll uncover the rich history behind each bottle, and indulge in tastings that bring the region's world-renowned flavors to life.

Before heading back to Porto, we'll experience the breathtaking beauty of the Douro Valley from a whole new angle, gliding along the Douro River on a serene cruise. As we sail between the terraced vineyards and rolling hills, you'll have the chance to fully immerse yourself in the region's tranquil landscapes, making for a perfect, unforgettable finale to the day.

